

7/29/2026 Meeting summary

Quick recap

The NVALAS board meeting began with personal updates, including Susie's new principal position and Oscar's job security concerns due to district budget issues. The group approved the June retreat minutes and reviewed the financial report, noting expenses for insurance and an upcoming ALAS conclave. Ramona reported on new sponsorships, including a \$3,000 commitment from Heidi Cavazos and potential partnerships with FAME and NABE. The calendar was discussed, highlighting upcoming events such as a Charlacon with Aaron Ford, meetings with the superintendent, and the fall mixer featuring Brian Benavidez. The La Semilla Institute was a major topic, with Shirley's vision for the next session focusing on "Corazon con Ciencia" and plans to move the dates to November or December. The board also discussed plans for the national ALAS conference, including travel arrangements and the need for group swag. Oscar presented a proposal for a spring awards event, aiming for a modest inaugural gathering. The conversation ended with expressions of excitement for the organization's momentum and future growth.

Next steps

Elena

- [Reach out to businesses \(e.g., Target, Lazy Dog, Kendra Scott\) for donations or auction items for the Spring Awards event.](#)

Jose

- [Work on organizing a "Noche Bohemia" with mariachi teachers for the upcoming fall social event.](#)

Oscar

- [Book flight and hotel for the ALAS conference.](#)
- [Follow up on membership renewals with members who have not yet paid \(Johnny and Isabelita Sanchez\).](#)
- [Continue developing the Spring Awards event plan, including securing a venue and potential sponsors.](#)

Ramona

- [Follow up with Jose regarding his boss's submission of travel costs for the conference, to potentially invite an additional person.](#)
- [Send the link to the embroidery shop options for swag to the team for feedback.](#)

Susie

- [Conduct one-on-one meetings with staff at Mountain View Elementary to gather feedback on what to keep and what to change.](#)
- [Finalize the dates for the upcoming La Semilla Institute session \(targeting November/December\) and create a flyer for approval.](#)

Collaboration

- [All Officers: Review the roles and responsibilities in the handbook and provide feedback to Elena.](#)
- [All Officers: Attend at least two of the three upcoming September events \(Charlacon with Aaron Ford, Superintendent meeting, Fall Mixer\).](#)
- [All Officers: Provide input on swag options for the conference.](#)

Summary

School Organization and Financial Updates

The meeting began with personal check-ins, where Jose shared his upcoming trip to Disneyland and Susie announced her new role as principal of Mountain View Elementary. Oscar reported ongoing job security concerns after the district questioned his assistant principal position and budget allocations. The group approved the June retreat minutes and reviewed the current financial status, with Elena presenting a detailed breakdown showing a beginning balance of \$30,000, no income in June, and expenses totaling \$1,387, resulting in an ending balance after insurance payments and travel costs. The conversation ended with Elena introducing a new organizational hub system where members can access documents and financial information, and discussing the need for review of revised roles and responsibilities in the bylaws.

Team Planning and Partnership Updates

The team discussed reviewing the handbook, with Ramona suggesting they delay this to allow new officers time to access and review their roles. Ramona announced a new \$3,000 partnership with Heidi Cavazos for a September event, while emphasizing the importance of setting appropriate boundaries with potential sponsors. The group reviewed upcoming events including a September 2nd dinner with Aaron Ford, scheduled superintendent meetings, and a fall mixer with Curriculum Associates featuring Brian Benavidez.

Partnership Progress for Educational Event

Elena and Ramona reported positive progress in securing partnerships with Filipino American Educators (FAME) and the National Association of Bilingual Educators (NABE) for an upcoming event. Ramona announced that Brian will be the keynote speaker, focusing on literacy with elements of La Semilla, storytelling, and Cynthia Vincente's concepts. The team discussed previous successful partnerships with NVASA, which contributed financially and provided venue support, and expressed hope for similar support from other partners. Jose mentioned plans to potentially organize a Noche Bohemia mariachi performance, while Silvia Lasos confirmed she would continue to sponsor future La Semilla events.

La Semilla Institute Event Planning

The group discussed the upcoming La Semilla Institute event, which will be titled "Corazón y Conciencia - Cultivating Sustainable Leadership." Shirley is finalizing her vision and mission for 2024, which focuses on integrating emotional and intellectual development in leadership, challenging traditional educational assumptions, and promoting culturally validating pedagogy for social justice. The team agreed to move the event dates to November or December and to begin planning for the spring La Semilla Institute, including identifying candidates for the chair position.

La Semilla Institute Planning Discussion

The team discussed plans for the next La Semilla Institute, which will feature a capstone project focused on cultural autobiography rather than just racial autobiography, aiming to challenge monoculturalism. Oscar noted significant growth in depth and complexity compared to previous versions, while Ramona and Elena expressed enthusiasm about the organization's evolving approach to professional development. The group also discussed a potential partnership opportunity, with Ramona and Elena declining a partnership proposal that focused too heavily on product sales rather than shared values and community impact.

Nevada Conference Planning Meeting

The team discussed plans for an upcoming conference in Nevada, where Ramona confirmed that the organization will cover \$5,000 worth of expenses including annual memberships, conference fees, and gala tickets for five attendees including Elena, Jose, Susie, Shirley, and Oscar. The group coordinated travel arrangements, with Elena and Oscar planning to leave Wednesday at 1 PM and Jose taking an early Thursday flight, while Ramona secured a partner to pay for a group dinner. The conversation ended with a discussion about purchasing conference merchandise, where Ramona

and Elena had visited a local embroidery shop to explore options for ethnic-themed swag representing their Latino heritage.

Conference Attire and Awards Planning

The team discussed plans for conference attire, with Ramona offering to share embroidery options and links for customizing polos. Oscar presented a detailed proposal for the inaugural spring awards event, suggesting a casual mixer format at FCC Family Support Center with potential for future growth, including potential partnerships with organizations like the Neon Museum. The group expressed strong support for the awards concept, with Elena suggesting fundraising opportunities through donations from local businesses. The conversation ended with updates on membership renewals and congratulations to Susie on her new principal position at Mountain View Elementary.